

**Osho** born Chandra Mohan Jain and also known as Bhagwan Shree Rajneesh was an Indian mystic and spiritual leader who used ancient parables, Zen stories, and modern jokes to deliver his teachings on mindfulness, ego, and freedom.

### ✦ Short Biography

- **Early Life:** Born on **December 11, 1931**, in Kuchwada, India, he spent his earliest years with his grandparents, developing a fiercely independent nature. He detailed his rebellious youth in his memoir, [\*Glimpses of a Golden Childhood\*](#).
- **Enlightenment & Career:** He stated he attained spiritual enlightenment on **March 21, 1953**, at age 21. After working as a philosophy professor, he traveled India as "Acharya Rajneesh," critiquing orthodox religion and socialism.
- **The Global Movement:** In 1974, he established an ashram in Pune, attracting thousands of Westerners. In 1981, his movement relocated to Oregon, USA, founding the intentional community **Rajneeshpuram**. Following severe legal, political, and internal conflicts, Osho was deported from the US in 1985.
- **Final Years:** He returned to India, renaming himself **Osho** in 1989. He passed away on **January 19, 1990**, in Pune, leaving behind a legacy of thousands of transcribed audio and video discourses.

### 📖 Three Famous Stories Told by Osho

Osho frequently retold classical Zen, Sufi, and Buddhist stories to break down the complex mechanisms of the human mind.

#### 1. The Centipede and the Frog (The Trap of Analysis)

A centipede was walking along happily during his morning routine. A frog looked at him in absolute disbelief and asked, *"How do you coordinate all your 100 legs? How do you know which leg to move first, which second, and which third?"*

The centipede stopped and admitted, *"I have never thought about it!"* He stood still, tried to analyze his walking, and suddenly found his legs entangled. He fell over in frustration and told the frog, *"Please never ask this question to anyone else! Life flows beautifully until you try to intellectualize and manage everything."*

- **The Lesson:** The mind destroys natural, spontaneous living by overanalyzing. True life is lived in spontaneous presence, not rigid mental control.

#### 2. The Freedom Parrot (The Safety of the Cage)

A man bought a beautiful, highly intelligent parrot and kept it in a golden cage. Every single day, the man would look at the parrot and repeat, *"Freedom! Freedom is the ultimate truth of life!"* The parrot learned the phrase perfectly and screamed *"Freedom!"* all day long.

One day, taking pity on the bird, the man decided to release it. He opened the cage door and stepped back. But the parrot clung to the iron bars with its claws, terrified of the open window, while still screaming at the top of its lungs: *"Freedom! Freedom!"*

- **The Lesson:** Humanity loves to talk and theorize about freedom, but we are deeply afraid of the vast unknown. People frequently choose the safe, comfortable confinement of their psychological habits over true liberation.

### **3. Buddha and the Muddy Water (Patience and Stillness)**

Gautama Buddha was traveling with his disciples when they stopped near a small lake. Feeling thirsty, Buddha asked his disciple, Ananda, to fetch him some water. When Ananda reached the water, a bullock cart had just driven through it, turning the water completely muddy and full of dead leaves. Ananda returned empty-handed, saying the water was too dirty to drink.

Buddha smiled and told him to wait. After an hour, Buddha sent Ananda back. By then, the mud had naturally settled to the bottom under its own weight, leaving the water crystal clear. Ananda brought the clean water back to Buddha.

- **The Lesson:** You cannot forcefully clear a troubled mind. When your mind is chaotic, do not force it to be calm. Simply sit silently, give it time, and the mud of your thoughts will settle on its own accord.